Learning progress: Your checklist

AI Training for Beginners

Self-study training: use AI/LLMs safely in everyday life

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File: `learning_progress.md`

https://github.com/mgunthner/AI-Training

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Learning progress: Your checklist

Here you can see where you stand in the training. Copy the file and check items off by replacing ☐ with ☑.

My learning path: ☐ Quick start ☐ Standard ☐ Advanced **Start date:** _____

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1. How to use the checklist

- **read:** You have worked through the cheatsheet.
- **practiced:** You have done the exercise (5 min.) with an AI service.
- **Path:** Shows from which learning path the topic is included.
  - **S** = Quick start (applies to everyone, including Standard and Advanced)
  - **St** = Standard (and Advanced)
  - **F** = Advanced only
- **Extra exercises** are voluntary. Note them under “Notes” if you did them.

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2. Topics

Start

No.	Topic	Path	read	practiced
00	Introduction handout	S	☐	–

Block A: Foundation

No.	Topic	Path	read	practiced
01	What is AI?	S	☐	☐
02	Tokens & context window	S	☐	☐
03	Model selection & free plans	S	☐	☐
04	Data privacy in everyday life	S	☐	☐

Block B: Good results

No.	Topic	Path	read	practiced
05	Prompt basics	S	☐	☐
06	Prompt techniques	St	☐	☐
07	Prior knowledge & context	St	☐	☐
08	Hallucinations & fact-checking	S	☐	☐
09	Temperature & sampling	F	☐	☐
10	Reasoning effort	St	☐	☐
11	The AI’s tools (tool use)	St	☐	☐

Block C: Risks

No.	Topic	Path	read	practiced
12	Prompt injection	S	☐	☐
13	Guardrails	St	☐	☐

Block D: Technology & costs

No.	Topic	Path	read	practiced
14	API, simply explained	F	☐	☐
15	Cost control	F	☐	☐

Block E: Agentic systems

No.	Topic	Path	read	practiced
16	Agents	F	☐	☐
17	MCP	F	☐	☐
18	Skills	F	☐	☐
19	Subagents	F	☐	☐
20	Advisor pattern	F	☐	☐
21	Running agents safely	F	☐	☐

Block F: Final

No.	Topic	Path	read	practiced
22	Law & compliance	St	☐	–
23	Everyday workflows & prompt library	St	☐	☐
24	Glossary & further learning	F	☐	–

Capstone (after the final test)

No.	Topic	Path	read	practiced
25	Capstone: My personal AI workflow assistant	St (optional), F (recommended)	☐	☐

"Read" = worked through the project instructions and Cheatsheet 25, "practiced" = project completed and graded with the capstone checklist (`06_capstone/checklist`).

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3. Tests

A test is passed at **75 %** or more. You don't get a grade for the entrance test – it only shows your starting point. Didn't pass? Repeat the topics from the solutions file and retake the test.

Test	Topics	Path	Date	Result (%)	Passed (≥ 75 %)
Entrance test	Prior knowledge	all		not graded	–
Quick test: quick start	01–05, 08, 12	S			☐
Test A: Foundation	01–04	St			☐
Test B: Good results	05–11	St			☐
Test C: Risks	12–13	St			☐
Test D: Technology & costs	14–15	F			☐
Test E: Agentic systems	16–21	F			☐
Test F: Final	22–24	St			☐
Final test	all blocks	F			☐

Note: **Test B** also covers topic 09, which only appears in the Advanced path. Standard path: skip questions 14–15, then the pass mark is 20 out of 26 points.

Capstone: No test of its own – you grade the final project with the capstone checklist (`06_capstone/checklist`), pass mark **17 out of 24 points**. Prerequisite: final test passed.

Topics to repeat:

- _____
- _____
- _____

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4. Self-assessment (scale 1–5)

1 = doesn't apply at all · **3** = partly · **5** = fully applies

Enter a number **before** (before Cheatsheet 01) and **after** (after completing your learning path). Statements marked **(F)** belong to the Advanced path.

Statement	Before	After
I can explain what an AI chatbot can and cannot do.		
I know which data does not belong in a chat.		
I can write a good prompt.		
I recognize made-up answers (hallucinations) and verify them.		
I recognize prompt injection (hidden instructions in third-party content).		
I can judge which model and which setting fit a task.		
I keep an eye on costs and limits. (F)		
I know what agents, APIs, and MCP are. (F)		
I can secure agents with minimal rights and permissions. (F)		

What has changed? What was your biggest aha moment?

_____

_____

_____

5. My prompt library

Collect successful prompts from day 1 in a separate note file (template in Cheatsheet 23). Tick off your progress here:

- ☐ Note file for the prompt library created
- ☐ First 3 prompts collected
- ☐ 10 prompts collected
- ☐ Prompts labeled with title, purpose, and example result
- ☐ Library carried into the capstone (`06_capstone/project_instructions`) – optional

Remember: only save **invented or anonymized** content.

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6. Notes

Topic	Extra exercises done?	My note / question (→ GitHub issue)
	☐	
	☐	
	☐	
	☐	
	☐	

Open question? Create an issue in the GitHub repo (template: `04_trainer/question_template`). Issues are public – no sensitive or personal data, anonymize content first.

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